The Odd Couple (Female Version)

By Neil Simon

(Florence is vacuuming, and Olive comes in. Olive sees her vacuuming and unplugs it. Florence begins winding up the cord, then Olive steps on it. After two tugs at the cord, Olive lifts her foot before the third. Florence falls while Olive laughs. They glare at each other and then turn their heads at the same time. Olive then sits down and picks up a newspaper from underneath the chair. Florence takes the vacuum into the kitchen and returns with a plate of spaghetti. She sits down and begins eating. Olive smells the spaghetti and goes into the bathroom. She comes out with a can of deodorizer, and she then sprays the spaghetti and slams the can on the table. Olive freezes as Florence continues into the introduction.)

INTRODUCTION

FLORENCE: *Meet my roommate, Olive the most UN-sensitive, UN-organized, UN-appreciative, UN-couth, woman (and I use that term loosely) on the planet. ARGHHH! (freezes in the act of some "obsessive-compulsive" act)*
OLIVE: *Ms. Manners here is Florence, who will probably die of exhaustion, excessive neatness and then demand to organize her own funeral. She is going to drive me crazy! But she is rather fun to antagonize. Yup, of all the possible roommate combinations we are definitely*
TOGETHER: *The Odd Couple by Neil Simon*

FLORENCE: All right, how much longer is this going to go on? Are you going to spend the rest of your life not talking to me?

OLIVE: You had your chance to talk last night. I begged you to come upstairs with me. I was looking for romance, and instead I got a petrified woman standing in my doorway. I don't want to hear the sound of your voice, do you understand?

FLORENCE: Si, Yo comprendo. Gracias.

OLIVE: *(gets a key out of back pocket and slams it on the table)* There! There's a key to the back door. Stick to your room and the hallway and you won't get hurt. *(turns to leave)*

FLORENCE: Oh Olive! Need I remind you, I pay half the rent and I'll go into any room I want!

OLIVE: Not in my apartment! Fine, but I don't want to see you! Cover the mirrors when you walk through the house. . . and I am sick and tired of smelling your cooking. I have had it up to here with your polyunsaturated oils. Now, get that spaghetti off of my table.

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FLORENCE: *(laughing hysterically)* That's funny. . . that's really funny. . .

OLIVE: *(getting angry)* what is so funny about that?

FLORENCE: It's not spaghetti, it's linguini.

OLIVE: *(looks at her like an insane person. She then grabs the plate of linguini and throws it at the opposite wall)*

FLORENCE: Are you crazy! Look at that mess! I'm not cleaning that up, it's your mess. Look at it hanging all over the walls.

OLIVE: I like it.

FLORENCE: You'd just leave it there wouldn't you, until it turns all brown and hard. . . yich! I'm cleaning it up.

OLIVE: *(grabbing her and putting her hands on her head)* If you touch one strand of that linguini. . . I will break every sinus in your head.

FLORENCE: Why? What did I do this time? What's bothering you? Is it the cooking, the cleaning, the crying?

OLIVE: I'll tell you exactly what's bothering me. It's the cooking, the cleaning, and the crying. It's the moose calls that open your ears at two o'clock in the morning. I can't take it anymore Florence, I'm cracking up. Everything you do irritates me, and when you're not here the things I know you're going to do when you come in irritate me. You leave me little notes on my pillow; we're all out of cornflakes F.U. It took me three hours to figure out that F.U. was Florence Unger! It's no one's fault Florence; we're just a rotten pair.

FLORENCE: I get the picture.

OLIVE: That's just the frame. The picture I haven't even painted yet. Every night in my diary, I write down the things you did that day that aggravate me. . . this is June, and so far I've filled it up till January. I haven't even put in about the Gazpacho Brothers yet.

FLORENCE: Oh! Is that what's bothering you. . . that I loused up your sex life?

OLIVE: What sex life, I can't even have dirty dreams, you come in and clean them up!

FLORENCE: *(pointing a finger at her)* I warned you not to make that date in the first place.

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OLIVE: *(grabbing finger, attempting to bite it)* Don't point that finger at me unless you intend to use it.

FLORENCE: Alright Olive get off my back. . . OFF! Do you hear me!

OLIVE: What's this? A display of temper? I haven't seen you really angry since I dropped my eyelashes in your pancake batter.

FLORENCE: Okay Olive, there's something I don't want to say, but if I say it. . . I think you'd better hear it.

OLIVE: I'm trembling all over. . . look how I'm trembling all over.

FLORENCE: You're a wonderful girl Olive. You've done everything for me. You took me in here, gave me a place to live and something to live for. If it weren't for you, I don't know what would have happened to me. You're the tops with me Olive.

OLIVE: If I've just been told off. . . I think I may have missed it.

FLORENCE: It's coming now.

OLIVE: Good.

FLORENCE: You're also one of the *biggest* slobs in the world.

OLIVE: I see.

FLORENCE: Unreliable,

OLIVE: Is that so?

FLORENCE: Undependable,

OLIVE: Is that it?

FLORENCE: And *indescribably* inefficient. There I'm done, now you've been told off. How do you like that?

OLIVE: Good, because now I'm going to tell you off. For eight months, I lived in this apartment. I thought I was miserable, I thought I was lonely. I took you in here because I thought we could help each other, but after three weeks of close personal contact. . . I have hives, shingles, and the heartbreak of psoriasis. I am growing old at twice the speed of sound. I have seven new liver spots on the back of my hand that look like the Big Dipper. Do me a favor Florence, move into the kitchen, live with your pots, your pans, your ladle, and your meat thermometer. I'm

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going to lie down now, because my teeth are coming loose, and I'm afraid if I drop them in here, you're going to get out your vacuum cleaner again. *(turns to bedroom)*

FLORENCE: *(after a pause)* Walk on the papers in there. . . I just cleaned the floors.

OLIVE: *(looks at her with a crazy glare)* In the kitchen! I want to get your head in the oven and cook it like a capon! *(chasing her)*

FLORENCE: *(squeals; runs into the bathroom and locks it)* You're going to find yourself in one nasty lawsuit!

OLIVE: It's no use running Florence, there are only six rooms and I know all of the shortcuts. *(goes through the bedroom and through a different door to the bathroom. Florence runs out of the door Olive just came in)*

FLORENCE: Is that how you settle your problems, like an animal? *(reaches for her purse)* This is tear gas. . . you lay one finger on me and you'll be using eye drops for the rest of your life!

OLIVE: You want to see how I settle my problems? I'll show you how I settle my problems! *(goes into the bedroom)*

FLORENCE: Alright! I warned you, I'm getting out my siren. *(pulls a siren out of her purse. Then she lifts it in the air and pushes the button. Nothing happens. She holds it to her ear, again nothing)* Olive? Have you been playing with my siren? *(banging it on the table)* Twenty-two fifty for a piece of Japanese-

OLIVE: *(slamming a suitcase on the table)* There! That is how I settle my problems!

FLORENCE: Where are you going?

OLIVE: Not me, you idiot! YOU! You're the one who's leaving! I can fix your siren so it will whistle for a cab!

FLORENCE: What are you talking about?

OLIVE: *(going to the kitchen, she gets pots and pans)* The marriage is over Florence. We're getting an annulment. I don't want to live with you anymore. I want you to pack your things, tie them up with your Saran Wrap, and get out!

FLORENCE: You mean actually move out?

OLIVE: Actually, physically, and immediately! *(puts the pots in the suitcase, then takes the case to the door and sets it down)* There! You're all packed.

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FLORENCE: You know, I have a good mind to really leave.

OLIVE: *(looking heavenward)* Why doesn't she hear me? I know I'm talking; I recognize the sound of my voice.

FLORENCE: Okay, but let it be on your conscience.

OLIVE: Let what be on my conscience?

FLORENCE: Get out of my house is what you said. I just wanted to get the record straight. Whatever happens to me is your responsibility, and may it be on your head!

OLIVE: Let ***what*** be on my head? Don't put things on my head! Take it ***off!***

FLORENCE: I left you plenty of food, all you have to do is heat it up. You can ask one of the neighbors how to light a match.

OLIVE: You're not leaving until you take it back!

FLORENCE: Take what back?

OLIVE: Let it be on your head. . . what is that, the curse of the cat people?

FLORENCE: I'd like to leave now.

OLIVE: Florence, we've been good friends for too long to end it this way. We're civilized people, let's just shake hands and part like gentlemen.

FLORENCE: *(looks at the outstretched hand and spits in it)*

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